

# Chiara Motta

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## EDUCATION

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| <b>University of California, Berkeley</b><br>Ph.D. in Business and Public Policy, Haas School of Business | Expected May 2027 |
| <b>Bocconi University</b><br>M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences, <i>summa cum laude</i>                | 2019              |
| <b>Bocconi University</b><br>B.Sc. in Economics and Social Sciences, <i>summa cum laude</i>               | 2016              |
| <b>University of British Columbia</b><br>Visiting Student                                                 | 2015              |

## FIELDS

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Labor Economics, Spatial Economics, Industrial Organization

## REFERENCES

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| <b>Patrick Kline</b> (advisor)<br>Department of Economics<br>UC Berkeley<br><a href="mailto:pkline@berkeley.edu">pkline@berkeley.edu</a> | <b>Matilde Bombardini</b><br>Haas School of Business<br>UC Berkeley<br><a href="mailto:mbombardini@berkeley.edu">mbombardini@berkeley.edu</a> | <b>Sydnee Caldwell</b><br>Haas School of Business<br>UC Berkeley<br><a href="mailto:scaldwell@berkeley.edu">scaldwell@berkeley.edu</a> |
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## JOB MARKET PAPER

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### **“Place-Based Policies and Labor Rationing”** (with Federico Cingano)

Place-based policies target high-unemployment areas, yet standard welfare evaluations assume that labor markets clear and wages adjust freely to labor demand. Exploiting a €26 billion subsidy program targeting Italy’s high-unemployment regions, where wage setting is institutionally constrained, we use three complementary research designs to trace the resulting labor demand shock through firms, workers, and local labor markets. Adjustment occurs through quantities rather than wages: subsidized firms expand employment through hiring and retention, incumbent workers’ earnings rise mainly because they work more weeks, and wages rise only for workers unconstrained by mandated wage floors. Employment at non-applicant firms does not fall, and wages remain unchanged. When wage adjustment is constrained and labor is rationed, standard welfare evaluations overstate the efficiency cost of place-based policies.

## WORKING PAPERS

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“The Cost of Buying American,” with Matilde Bombardini, Andres Gonzalez-Lira, and Bingjing Li.  
*Revise & Resubmit, American Economic Review.*

“It is Never too Late: Educational Television and Human Capital Accumulation,” with Filippo Palomba.

## SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

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“Monopsony Power Across Firms,” with Sydnee Caldwell, Ingrid Haefele, and Joerg Heining

“Product and Labor Market Power: Evidence from Firm-to-Firm Networks,” with Eugenia Menaguale

“The Labor Market Effects of Competition: Evidence from the Hudson’s Bay Company,” with Lukas Leucht and Davis Kedrosky

“Learning, Teaching, and the Diffusion of Ideas,” with Jinci Liu and Dominik Wehr

“Knowing the Floor: Jobseekers’ Knowledge of Collective Agreements,” with Marina Schwab

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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Microeconomics (EWMBA 201A), UC Berkeley Haas (Evening/Weekend MBA) Fall 2024, 2025, 2026  
*Cheit Award for Excellence in Teaching* (2026) — selected by the Evening & Weekend MBA students, Haas School of Business  
*Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award* (2026) — UC Berkeley, given to about 10% of GSIs campus-wide  
Berkeley Business Academy for Youth, guest lecture, UC Berkeley Haas Fall 2024  
Microeconomics; Markets, Organizations and Incentives, Bocconi University 2019–2020  
Macroeconomics; Macroeconomics I – Global Scenarios, Bocconi University 2019–2020

## RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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Graduate Student Researcher, UC Berkeley 2021–2024  
Visiting Researcher, Structural Economic Analysis Directorate, Bank of Italy 2022, 2025  
Pre-doctoral Researcher, Bocconi University 2019–2020  
Economics Intern, Competition and Markets Authority 2018  
Summer Intern, European Commission (DG Competition) 2017

## HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, & GRANTS

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Fisher Center Research Grant 2026  
University of California President's Lindau Nobel Meetings Fellow 2025  
Opportunity Lab Place-Based Policy Initiative 2024, 2025  
Spiller PhD Fellowship; Simpson ABD Fellowship in Global, International and Area Studies 2025  
UC Berkeley IRLE Social Sciences Research Pathways; UCB Student Opportunity Fund 2025  
Visiting Scholar Program, Italian Social Security Institute (INPS) 2024  
Berkeley Economists for Equity Research Grant; Williamson PhD Fellowship Fund 2023  
Price Theory Summer Camp, Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago 2023  
University of California, Berkeley Scholarship 2020–2025  
*Marco Fanno* Scholarship, UniCredit Foundation 2020–2022  
Bank of Italy: Research Fellowship; *Donato Menichella* Scholarship (outstanding distinction) 2022; 2020  
IGIER Visiting Student, Bocconi University 2017–2018

## CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

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2026 Urban Economics Association North American Meeting (Chicago; also discussant), All California Labor Economics Conference, Innsbruck Faculty Research Seminar, O-Lab Applied Microeconomics Conference on Economic Opportunity, Berkeley Labor Symposium, Oliver E. Williamson Seminar, Berkeley Labor Lunch, Berkeley Trade Lunch, Berkeley Labor Seminar\*  
2025 Berkeley Labor Lunch, Berkeley Trade Lunch, OEW Student Seminar, AIEL Workshop on Labour Market Policies, Lindau Nobel Laureates Meeting, OpportunityLab Research Workshop  
2024 OEW Student Seminar, Bocconi CLEAN Workshop  
2023 IO Workshop, Economic History Workshop, OEW Student Seminar, Bocconi CLEAN Workshop  
2022 OEW Student Seminar, Bocconi CLEAN Workshop

\*scheduled

## SERVICE & OTHER

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Mentor: *Social Science Research Pathways*, *Mentoring Women in Economics*, *Lead The Future*, Berkeley URAP  
Programming: Stata, R, Python, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X | Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), French (basic)

Last updated: October 2, 2026